Great war, when the Indian help was needed the most, promises about self-government were made' (and where Gandhi played a pivotal role in recruiting Indian soldiers for the war effort) but that '[u]p till now, the executive was never made responsible to the Legislative Assembly and the Viceroy had the veto power, which rendered all the efforts of the elected members futile'.[20] It is also why Bhagat Singh wrote to young political workers on 2 February 1931 about how '[d]uring the last two years the British politicians have been trying to undo Montagu's promise for another dole of reforms to be bestowed every ten years' and that '[w]e can see what they have decided about the future' and about how they had 'to form a clear idea about our situation, so that we may enlighten the masses and prepare them for a further struggle'.[21] Bhagat Singh is impatient for freedom, but not so naïve as to not recognise the need for compromise. Ultimately, his belief in the masses would see India through, and in this commitment, he enjoins the youth everywhere to take up Marxism. The road ahead would not be easy, as he explains in his address to the young political workers. He proceeds with caution, pointing out, 'let me warn the sincere young workers who seriously mean a revolution, that harder times are coming' because of his enduring distrust of the upper classes of India:

> revolution means the complete overthrow of the existing social order and its replacement with the socialist order. For that purpose our immediate aim is the achievement of power. As a matter of fact, the state, the government machinery is just a weapon in the hands of the ruling class to further and safeguard its interest. We want to snatch and handle it to utilise it for the consummation of our ideal, i.e. the social reconstruction on new, i.e. Marxist, basis. [22]

The weaknesses of Bhagat Singh, as Bipin Chandra has pointed out while recognizing his undoubted qualities as a leader of outstanding abilities, are that his movement failed to become an urban phenomenon.[23] Bhagwan Josh, in his magisterial three-volume chronicle of Indian communism, remarked that Bhagat Singh committed the cardinal strategic error of equating the Indian colonial state with the Russian Czarist state when the two were so different.[24] Grewal has argued that the 'most striking weakness' of Bhagat Singh lay in his failure to account for the structure of feudal